# Björn Thor Arnarson

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## Employment and Affiliations

Researcher, *ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit* June 2025–
Affiliated Researcher, *Department of Economics, Lund University* 2025–
Affiliate, *CESifo* 2024–
Affiliated Research Fellow, *Economic Policy Research Unit (EPRU)* 2017–

### Previous

Assistant Professor, *University of Copenhagen* May 2021–Sep 2026
Marie Skłodowska-Curie Research Fellow, *University of Copenhagen* Jan 2019–May 2021
Research project BRIDGE, financed by the EU's Horizon 2020 programme
Post-doctoral Researcher, *University of Copenhagen* Jan 2017–Jan 2019
Financed by a grant from the Innovation Fund. Focus on export promotion
Affiliated Researcher, *Centre for Öresund Studies, Lund University* 2017–2025
Post-doctoral Researcher, *Lund University* Oct–Dec 2016
Earlier Positions, *Reykjavik* 2007–2011
Chief Economist, Iceland Chamber of Commerce (full-time), Dec 2009–2011; Researcher, Institute of Economic Studies (part-time), 2009–2011; Business Journalist, Fréttablaðið (summers only), 2007 and 2008

*Paternity leave: 7 months (16 weeks in 2018–2019, 15–29 April 2018, and 1 March to 21 May 2019) and 3 months during PhD studies (part-time work).*

## Education

**PhD** in Economics, Lund University, Sweden 2011–2016
**MA** in Economics, Boston University, USA 2008–2009
**BS** in Economics, University of Iceland, Iceland 2005–2008
**Exchange student** in Economics, University of Oklahoma, USA 2006–2007

### Pedagogical Training

Teaching and Learning in Higher Education (UCPH) 2021–2022
Final project: Open and Unstructured Assignment in International Economics
University Teaching and Supervision Course for Academic Staff 2021

## Publications

Globalization and the Gender Gap in Mental Well-being. *Journal of International Economics* (2026), vol. 161, pp. 104253. (with A. N. David, B. S. Javorcik and J. R. Munch).
Linking Local Services to Global Manufactures. *The Scandinavian Journal of Economics* (2022), vol. 124(1), pp. 3–34. (with Joakim Gullstrand).

How a School Holiday Led to Persistent COVID-19 Outbreaks in Europe. *Scientific Reports* (2021), vol. 11, pp. 24390. *(single-authored)*.

The Superstar and the Followers: Intra-Firm Product Complementarity in International Trade. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* (2020), vol. 177, pp. 277–304. *(single-authored)*.

The Paternity Leave Act in Iceland: Implications for Gender Equality in the Labour Market. *Applied Economics Letters* (2010), vol. 17(7), pp. 677–680. (with Aparna Mitra).

## Working Papers and Work in Progress

Growing Together and Apart: Scale Economies and Labor Specialization in Global Value Chains (with Magnus T. Buus, Andreas Moxnes, Jakob R. Munch and Chong Xiang). *R&R, Journal of Political Economy*.

CESifo Working Paper 12710

R&D Employment and Transmission in Trade and MNE Networks: Evidence from an R&D Tax Reform (with Magnus T. Buus, Jakob R. Munch and Georg Schaur).

ROCKWOOL Foundation Study Paper 217

Knowledge Spillovers from Cross-Border Commuters: Evidence from a Natural Experiment (with Jakob R. Munch, Morten G. Olsen and Emil A. L. Simonsen).

ROCKWOOL Foundation Study Paper 215

International Spillovers from Supplying Superstars: Evidence from Firm-to-Firm Linkages (with Jonas Slaathaug Hansen).

The Intangible Gains from Trade (with Martina Magli and Andreas Moxnes).

Bridging Trade Barriers: Evaluating Multi-Product Models of Exporting *(single-authored)*. *Dormant*.

Working Paper 2015:6, Lund University, Department of Economics

## Book Chapters and Monographs

*Omstilling på Arbejdsmarkedet: Globalisering, Automatisering og Uddannelse*. Syddansk Universitetsforlag, Odense, 2023 (with J. R. Munch, A. N. Christensen, D. Hémous, A. Humlum, B. Javorcik, B. B. Meyer, M. Olsen, P. Plato, M. Rasmussen and E. Vestergaard).

*Exports and Externalities*. Doctoral thesis, Lund University, November 2016. Opponent: Andreas Moxnes.

## Grants

ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit grant, *Disruption and Structural Change: Challenges and Opportunities in the Labor Market* (DKK 9.6m; Joint PI with Jakob Munch) — 2024–2028

ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit grant, *Labor Market Effects of Automation, Offshoring and Multinationals* (USD 1,200,000; co-recipient; PI: Jakob Munch) — 2019–2023

Seed financing, Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen (DKK 40,000; sole applicant) — 2020

Seed financing, Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen (DKK 62,000; sole applicant) — 2019

Marie Skłodowska-Curie grant, project BRIDGE, *Labour Market Integration: Consequences of Cross-Border Commuting*. EU Horizon 2020, grant no. 79367 (DKK 1.58m; sole applicant) — 2018

EPRN network project grant, *The Labour Market Effects of the Öresund Bridge* (DKK 330,000; sole applicant) — 2017

Handelsbanken project grant, *Local Conditions and Global Firms* (SEK 1.5m; co-applicant) 2016

Conference and travel grant, Stiftelsen Siamon 2015, 2016

Travel grant, Stiftelsen för Främjande av Ekonomisk Forskning 2014, 2015, 2016

## Teaching

Lecturer (course responsible), Advanced International Trade, *University of Copenhagen* Fall 2021–2023

Supervision of five MSc and two BSc students

Teaching assistant, *Lund University* 2012–2016

Introductory Macroeconomics, International Trade and Introductory Microeconomics (undergraduate); Economic Integration and Advanced Trade Theory (MSc)

Instructor, *Reykjavik University* 2010–2011

Lecturer, Introductory Macroeconomics; teaching assistant, Applied Statistics (undergraduate)

## Research Visits

LMU Munich July 2026

CESifo, Munich July 2024

## Conferences and Invited Seminars

**2026:** RMET (Banff); DIEW (Aarhus); Scientific Workshop on Productivity, German Council of Economic Experts and DIW Berlin (Berlin); ETSG (Exeter); ROCKWOOL Foundation Annual Internal Workshop (Berlin); OECD LIFT seminar, Paris (scheduled).

**2025:** Swedish Network for European Studies in Economics and Business (SNEE); invited seminar, ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit.

**2024:** NOITS (Oslo); SNEE (Lund); CESifo Area Conference on the Global Economy.

**2023:** Invited seminar, Icelandic Economists Abroad conference (University of Iceland); EPRN Copenhagen; SNEE (Lund).

**2021:** Invited seminar for Business Sweden.

**2019:** Road to Exporting, Copenhagen.

**2018:** Moscow International Economics Conference (Moscow); ADI Conference (Copenhagen); SNEE (Lund).

**2017:** Empirical Investigations in Trade and Investment, Yogyakarta (FREIT); invited seminar, Örebro University; NOITS conference (Helsinki); LETC conference (Slovenia, FREIT); ADI Conference (Copenhagen); SNEE (Lund).

**2016:** Invited seminars at the University of Copenhagen and IFN Stockholm; NOITS (Oslo); ADI Conference (Copenhagen); Lund University; ETSG (Helsinki); Summer School on Urban Growth and Agglomeration (Barcelona); Summer School on Economic Modeling and Inference (Aarhus).

**2015:** ETSG (Paris); Summer School on Panel Data Methods, Jeffrey Wooldridge (Thessaloniki); NOITS (Copenhagen); GEP Postgraduate Conference (University of Nottingham); Lund University; Danish International Economics Workshop (Aarhus); invited seminar, Sydsvenska Handelskammaren (Malmö).

**2014:** ERSA Summer School; NOITS conference; Nordic Summer Symposium in Macroeconomics; Lund University; ETSG.

## Professional Service

*Conference organization:* organizer of the NOITS conference, Copenhagen 2025 and Iceland 2021, and web coordinator of the network homepage (www.noits.org). NOITS is the annual Nordic conference in international economics.

*Refereeing:* American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; Economic Journal; European Economic Review; European Review of Economic History; Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization; Scandinavian Journal of Economics; Review of International Economics; Review of World Economics; Economics of Innovation and New Technology; The International Trade Journal; Technological Forecasting & Social Change; Rannís (the Icelandic Research Fund).

## Policy Work and Other Writing

"Trump og tollar: Fórn á við margfalda íslenska verðmætasköpun – ár eftir ár?" *Vísbending*, May 2025.

*The Road to Exporting* (RoadtoExporting.dk): lead designer of the research-backed policy website, with Jakob Munch and Georg Schaur. Financed by the Innovation Fund. Site sunset in 2026.

Four commissioned reports for the *Institute of Economic Studies, University of Iceland*, on Icelandic agriculture and EU accession and on the economic impact of the Harpa concert hall, with Dadi Mar Kristofersson and Sveinn Agnarsson, 2010–2012.

Five reports for the *Iceland Chamber of Commerce* on business conditions, business taxation and capital controls, and main editor of the status report on the Icelandic economy, 2010–2011.

## Languages

Icelandic (native), English (fluent), Swedish (fluent), Danish (intermediate).